



U.S. ARMY COMBAT CAPABILITIES DEVELOPMENT COMMAND

**Army Research Office
Trusted Partner Program
Industry Day Brief**

07 MAY 2026

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CUI Category	OPSEC	
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WELCOME



AGENDA

- Technical Overview
 - Q&A
- Contracting Overview
 - Q&A
- Wrap Up

Trusted Partner Program - Draft Solicitation

● Active

Opportunity

Notice ID
W911NF26RA009

Related Notice
(blank)

Contract Opportunity Type
Presolicitation

Contract Line Item Number
(blank)

Inactive Dates
Jun 13, 2026

Inactive Policy
15 days after response date

Response Date
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Department/Ind. Agency
DEPT OF DEFENSE

Sub-tier
DEPT OF THE ARMY

Major Command
AMC

Sub Command 1, 2, 3
ACC

ACC-CTRS

ACC-APG

Office
W6QK ACC-APG DURHAM



TECHNICAL OVERVIEW



- Overall goal
- Technical areas
- Interdisciplinary areas
- Security



TRUSTED PARTNER PROGRAM (TPP)

OVERALL GOAL



BLUF: TPP

- An innovative, enterprise-level program that is flexible, adaptive, and responsive to Army RDT&E needs within a dynamic operational environment
- Enables
 - Rapid CUI/SEC/TS contracting with external academic partners
 - Competitive rapid start on RDTE projects agnostic of technical field
 - A range of TRL levels
- Plan: Pilot award of ~ 5



ACTIVITY SCOPE IS INCLUSIVE OF BUT NOT EXCLUSIVE TO



- Basic and applied research
- Data science and analytics
- Technology development
- Digital Architecture
- Modeling and simulation
- Experimentation and testbed development
- Integration and demonstration
- Technology Transition to military capabilities

TECHNICAL AREAS



- **Biology (non-medical focus):** Exploring the potential of biological systems for Army applications, including synthetic biology, biomaterials, and bio-integrated technologies, including cognitive enhancement and integrated sensors.
- **Material Science:** This research area focuses on producing and analyzing advanced materials and their interactions. This includes understanding how materials behave and interact under extreme conditions, such as weapon impacts.
- **Electronics:** Advancing capabilities in sensing, counter-sensing, electronic warfare, and spectrum protection.
- **Chemistry:** Designing and developing advanced materials with exceptional properties, including lightweight strength, self-healing capabilities, and novel manufacturing processes. Developing innovative solutions for power generation, storage, conversion
- **Information Sciences:** Leveraging computational power, AI, and secure networks to enhance military operations. Research includes using artificial intelligence for decision-making, investigating human-technology teaming, and securing information across all operational domains through advanced cyber defense and encryption.
- **Physics:** Exploring the frontiers of quantum computing/information, advanced timing technologies, photonic/electronic devices based on emerging quantum materials, and directed energy technologies (including lasers).

INTERDISCIPLINARY AREAS



- **Applied Artificial Intelligence (AAI):**
focused on the rapid integration of AI
- **Biomanufacturing (BIO):**
harnessing living systems to produce capabilities at scale,
- **Contested Logistics Technologies (LOG):**
overcoming the challenges of disrupted or denied logistical pathways
- **Quantum and Battlefield Information Dominance (Q-BID):**
advanced communications capabilities in degraded or denied conditions, maneuver in the electromagnetic spectrum, and sense adversary capabilities
- **Scared Directed Energy (SCADE):**
the rapid scaling of high-energy lasers and high-power microwave systems and proactive warfighter protection
- **Scaled Hypersonics (SHY):**
scaling production, lowering costs, and widely fielding hypersonic weapons

TRUSTED PARTNER SECURITY



TIER	FACILITY CLEARANCE*		PERSONNEL CLEARANCE		IT INFRASTRUCTURE		SUBJECT MATTER EXPERTISE (SME) AND CAPABILITIES	
CUI	Not Applicable	✓	Active DCSA Adjudicated Tier 1 Clearance Possible due diligence review	✓	Cybersecurity Maturity Model Certification (CMMC) Program Tier II: 110 NIST SP 800-171 R2	✓	Facility Subject Matter Capabilities (i.e. resources behind the fence). cleared personnel with SME	✓
SECRET	Secure facilities/infrastructure with personnel access controls and active clearance	✓	Active DCSA Adjudicated Tier 3 Clearance	✓	National Industrial Security Program (NISP) SIPRnet on-site or access	✓	Facility SME Capabilities (i.e. resources behind the fence). cleared personnel with SME	✓
TOP SECRET	Secure facilities/infrastructure with personnel access controls and active clearance	✓	Active DCSA Adjudicated Tier 5 Clearance	✓	National Industrial Security Program (NISP) JWICS on-site or access	✓	Facility SME Capabilities (i.e. resources behind the fence). cleared personnel with SME	✓
Handling and Control								
SCI	Sensitive Compartmentalized Information Facility (SCIF)	✓	Have required Security Clearance and SCI access	✓	Defense Counterintelligence and Security Agency (DCSA) Facility Security requirements	✓	Facility SME Capabilities (i.e. resources behind the fence). cleared personnel with SME	✓
SAP	Appropriate Special Access Program (SAP) Facility Type	✓	Have required Security Clearance and read into SAP Program	✓	Defense Counterintelligence and Security Agency (DCSA) Facility Security requirements	✓	Facility SME Capabilities (i.e. resources behind the fence). cleared personnel with SME	✓

* Requirement for a facility clearance may be met if PI has access and authorization to use a facility outside their Institute for Higher Education and that facility meets facility clearance standards (i.e. University/PI has agreement to use facilities at a partner location that meets facility clearance standards).

[Links to externally facing websites](#)

TECHNICAL AREA MAPPING



	Biology	Material Science	Electronic	Chemistry	Information Sciences	Physics	
Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI)							Tier 1 Clearance
Collateral Secret (SEC)							Tier 3 Clearance
SEC/SCI, SEC/SAP, all Top Secret (TS)							Tier 5 Clearance

Drop Down Selection

Category explanation

Significant	World/national leader in the field, with 5+ faculty or staff members with clearance and SME, and significant infrastructure "behind the fence" to do work in this field
Strong	World/national leader in the field, with 5+ faculty or staff members with SME, and significant infrastructure
Established	World/national leader in the field, with 3-5 faculty or staff members with clearance and SME, and significant infrastructure
Spiky	World/national leader in the field, with 1-2 faculty or staff members with clearance and SME, and significant infrastructure
Moderate	5+ faculty or staff members with SME, and significant infrastructure
Minor	<5 faculty or staff members with SME, and some infrastructure
Interest	<5 faculty or staff members with SME OR some infrastructure
None	No personnel or infrastructure and no interest

THANK YOU.

Q&A



INDUSTRY DAY FOR THE TRUSTED PARTNER PROGRAM (TPP) W911NF-26-R-A009

Briefer Name: Army Contracting Command,
Aberdeen Proving Ground
Research Triangle Park Division

DATE: 7 MAY 2026

- Contracting Overview
 - Basis for Award
 - Instructions for Proposal submissions
 - Evaluations for Proposal submissions

- Wrap-up
 - Questions/Comments on Draft RFP

Government TPP Team

- *Tahissha Holman, **Contracting Officer***
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~Please use the chat function to ask questions throughout the briefing.~

Key Information

- Solicitation Number: **W911NF-26-R-A009**
- Program Name: **Trusted Partner Program (TPP)**
- Customer: Army Research Office (ARO)
- Contracting Division : US Army Contracting Command,
Research Triangle Park
- Supporting: All Academia and Associated Research
Institutions

CONTRACTING OVERVIEW (Sections L& M Highlights)

Basis for Award

The Government anticipates awards of up to five or more Indefinite Delivery/Indefinite Quantity (ID/IQ) contracts in support of the Trusted Partner Program. This is an estimate, and the Government reserves the right to award a different number of contracts, including more or less than the anticipated range, or to make no award.

Awards will be made to the most responsible Offerors providing their overall best valued proposals to the Government.

- Appropriate consideration will be given to five (5) evaluation factors:
- Technical
- Management
- Past Performance
- **Small Business Participation*
- Cost

Instructions for Proposal Submission

Two Phase Process

Phase I – Pre-Evaluation Screening Compliance (*i.e. pg count, sam.gov registration*)

Phase II – Evaluation of Volumes 1-5

Phase I- Pre-Evaluation Screening Compliance

Volume	Volume Name	File Name	Page Limit
I	Technical (Factor 1)	Volume 1 XXX Technical Proposal (date). doc/.pdf	30
II	Management (Factor 2)	Volume 2 XXX Management Proposal (date).doc/.pdf	10
III	Past Performance (Factor 3)	Volume 3 XXX Past Performance Proposal (date).doc/.pdf	None
IV	Small Business Participation (Factor 4)	Volume 4 XXX Small Business Participation (date) .doc/.pdf	None
V	Cost	Volume 5 XXX Cost Proposal (date) .doc/.pdf	None

Phase II – Evaluation of Volumes 1-5

Phase II – Volume 1: Technical

Areas of technical evaluation include:

- (a) Technical capability to serve as a Trusted Partner and perform complex research that meets program objectives
- (b) Submission of Secure Facilities Demonstration Video
- (c) Assessment of expertise against six (6) core technical fields and six (6) critical interdisciplinary technical areas as noted in the Statement of Objectives (SOO)
- (d) Demonstrated Capabilities of Subfactors (All of Equal Importance):
 - Subfactor 1.1: Technical Expertise & Alignment
 - Subfactor 1.2: Research Approach & Innovation
 - Subfactor 1.3: Facilities & Secure Infrastructure

Phase II – Volume 2: Management

The management approach will be evaluated to determine the Offeror's overall management approach and their capability to successfully execute the contract. The management approach shall clearly meet the requirements as described in section L.

- L-3.2.1 – Security Management Plan

- L-3.2.2 – Program, Personnel, and IP Management

- L-3.2.3 – Collaboration Plan

Phase II – Volume 3: Past Performance

The Government will evaluate the Offeror's record of performance as it relates to ALL solicitation requirements; including cost, schedule, performance and management of subcontractors.

Offerors shall identify up to three (3) recent and relevant projects of similar size, scope, and complexity demonstrating their ability to perform the specified task within the last five (5) years

Phase II – Volume 4: Small Business Participation

For Other Than Small Business (OTSB) Offerors, the Government will evaluate Small Business Participation based solely on the submission of an acceptable Small Business Contracting Plan in accordance with FAR 52.219-9. To be eligible for award, an OTSB Offeror's Subcontracting Plan must achieve a rating of 'Acceptable.'

Phase II – Volume 5: Cost

The Government will provide a Sample Task for the Offerors to evaluate.

The Offeror's cost proposal should reflect:

- Cost Reasonableness
- Cost Realism
- Completeness

Questions

WRAP UP



- Summary
- Recommendations
- Key Takeaways
- Action Items
- Next Steps



THANK YOU.

